

Bar shapes

The scanner reads one line of pixels at a time and never looks above or below it. Any shape whose horizontal cross-section is the same at every height therefore reads exactly like a plain rectangle — which makes this document a question of how the bins should look, not of what works. All three below were rendered and scanned back at three densities; all three named all three bins every time.

What is *not* here is rounded corners. Rounding narrows a bar near its ends, which widens the gap there — and the gaps are the ruler everything else is measured against. Scanned back at 14 samples per unit, a generous radius reported 21.5 and split three markers into five detections; even a barely-there radius still reported 15. The bins were still identified, but *unit px* is the number you size the print by, and a shape that quietly inflates it is worse than no shape at all.

Bars

The baseline. Every scan line across it measures the same widths.

Slanted

A sheared bar is exactly as wide at every height, so it reads identically to the baseline. Purely a matter of looks.

Chevron

Sheared one way above the midline and the other below it — also constant in width at every height, so also identical to read.

Bars

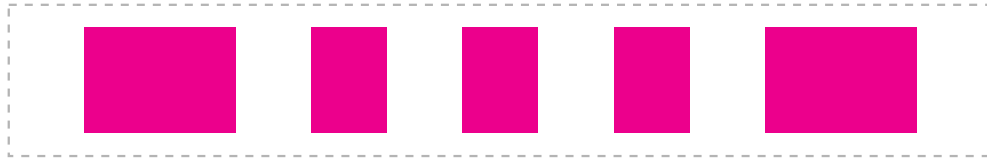
The baseline. Every scan line across it measures the same widths.

MARKER 1 · YELLOW · ONE WIDE BAR



Bin: _____

MARKER 2 · MAGENTA · 2 WIDE BARS



Bin: _____

MARKER 3 · CYAN · 3 WIDE BARS



Bin: _____

Slanted

A sheared bar is exactly as wide at every height, so it reads identically to the baseline. Purely a matter of looks.

MARKER 1 · YELLOW · ONE WIDE BAR



Bin: _____

MARKER 2 · MAGENTA · 2 WIDE BARS



Bin: _____

MARKER 3 · CYAN · 3 WIDE BARS



Bin: _____

Chevron

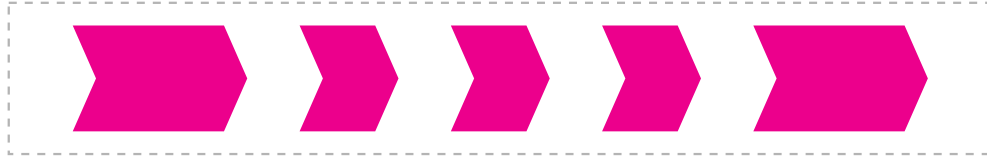
Sheared one way above the midline and the other below it — also constant in width at every height, so also identical to read.

MARKER 1 · YELLOW · ONE WIDE BAR



Bin: _____

MARKER 2 · MAGENTA · 2 WIDE BARS



Bin: _____

MARKER 3 · CYAN · 3 WIDE BARS



Bin: _____